

When it comes to gaming, overclocking your graphics card can significantly improve your in-game frame rates. It's also easier to overclock them, thanks to multiple options of utility software. While CPU overclocking doesn't really offer a considerable boost in gaming performance, you will observe better results with graphics cards. RAM modules can also be overclocked but they won't provide a significant overall performance boost. When it comes to phones, increasing the clock speeds will offer a snappier experience while navigating the UI with better performance in applications.

frying up the components. Apart from the heat issue, overclocking your CPU might involve playing around with the BIOS. Modifications made to it might potentially affect other parts of your PC. Hence, you need to be extra careful.

THE INDIAN OC SCENE

Overclocking is a global phenomenon and you'll come across several enthusiasts in forums and Facebook groups. Most of the action happens around competitions where the participants upload screenshots of their clock speeds and voltages. The participant with the highest clock is given the title of the

and high-speed RAM modules. This is a massive obstacle to get started with overclocking in the first place. High-end premium boards don't get picked off the shelves as quickly as the entry-level ones, so over time, the stocks of such boards have dwindled. Premium boards capable of handling overclocking get an additional price bump and they also struggle to stay in stock. This makes it harder for enthusiasts to get their hands on these motherboards since international shipping increases the price even more. You can have a relative or friend coming down to India from the US to get you a motherboard at a much lower price. However, there are people who still follow it as a hobby.

We spoke to a couple of well-known names in the Indian overclocking scene about their experiences. Harshal Tank used to be quite regular at overclocking events back in the days has now moved on to overclocking components in his own sweet time at home. And not just regular overclocking, Harshal goes completely bonkers with canisters of LN2 to reach high clock speeds. Although he has a busier lifestyle than before, he overclocked the Intel Core i7-8700K to 6.2GHz using LN2 earlier this year. He plans on giving it another go soon since the results weren't the numbers that he wished to achieve.

Another popular Indian overclocker we talked to was Shatul Durlabhji aka Toolius. While Shatul keeps overclocking on his personal capacity with almost every hardware he can get, he's also quite active on global overclocking competitions such as HWBOT. Shatul has also represented India in a few competitions abroad. He has been quite prominent in the scene during its peak and continues to encourage and help out beginners to start their overclocking journey. His place looks like what an overclocker's command center would look like with huge canisters of LN2 lying in the corner and several motherboards casually sitting over his desk.

GETTING STARTED

In the following sections, we will guide you through a step by step process of overclocking your components including your CPU, graphics card, RAM and peripherals. This is where your overclocking journey begins. **1**



Overclocked components generate heat, a lot of it!

RISKS

The biggest risk with overclocking is damaging your components from too much heat. If you're planning to overclock your components, it's always best to check whether your cooling system will be able to handle it. When it comes to CPUs, you should definitely switch from your stock cooler. For the best practical results, it's best to install a liquid cooling system. However, if you wish to take things to the next level, there's always Liquid Nitrogen or Helium. For graphics cards, the stock coolers should be enough to achieve higher speeds that will give you the desired performance boost. If you still want to push the clocks, then you can replace the stock cooling with a liquid cooling kit. Your phone will run hotter at a higher clock which will also eat up a lot of battery. Hence, you get a lower battery capacity and potentially risk

winner after everything is verified. While these events go on, beginners also try their hands where the experts are always eager to help them out. Speaking of the local scene, there haven't been major events or competitions surrounding overclocking for more than a couple of years. The ones that happened were part of a bigger event or product launch. It was sort of an activity where interested folks could watch in awe as Liquid Nitrogen was poured and massive clock speeds were hit. We don't know whether the onlookers actually got into overclocking later but it seemed more like a spectator sport.

Overclocking in India doesn't witness a high level of enthusiasm or participation. Let's not forget that this hobby is quite expensive since you'll have to literally splurge a lot of money on premium motherboards, unlocked CPUs, graphics cards (if you're overclocking them)